

IT IS TIME TO EMULATE JESUS

TEXT: John 14:12-14 (NKJV) “*Most assuredly, I say to you, he who believes in Me, the works that I do he will do also; and greater works than these he will do, because I go to My Father.* ¹³ *And whatever you ask in My name, that I will do, that the Father may be glorified in the Son.* ¹⁴ *If you ^[c]ask anything in My name, I will do it.*”

INTRO: Today’s message is a set-up for Pentecost Sunday. When Susan preached on Mother’s Day, she made a statement that led to today’s message. She mentioned that, “*We should emulate Jesus!*”

Dictionary.com say’s emulate means “*Imitate with effort to equal or surpass.*” This is exactly what our text encourages. Jesus said that if He returned to the Father, the Father would send the Holy Spirit, and Christ followers would do “*Greater works*” than Jesus did!!! Really?

Seriously? How is that possible in light of the fact that Jesus:

- Opened blinded eyes...
- Unstopped deaf ears...
- Cleansed the lepers...
- Raised the dead...
- Calmed the angry sea...
- Preached the gospel to the poor...
- Lived a sinless life...
- Conquered death...
- Embarrassed principalities...
- Established the Church...
- Changed the dispensation from law to grace...
- Divided time from BC to AD...

And we are supposed to imitate Him in an attempt to equal or surpass what He did? You gotta be kidding me!

The answer is YES! ***“Greater things shall you do!”*** The question is how?

JESUS GAVE US THE HOLY SPIRIT AS A HELPER

I would remind us that Jesus never did one miracle until He was baptized by John in the Jordan River and the Holy Spirit descended upon Him in the form of a dove.

Most Bible scholars agree that Jesus was not only baptized in water by John, but He was also baptized in the Holy Spirit at the same time.

Jesus never performed one miracle until He was baptized in the Holy Spirit. Every miracle He performed, He did so, not as God - but as a man anointed by the Holy Spirit.

This is the reason He could confidently declare that once He went back to Heaven and dispatched the Holy Spirit that Christ followers could do “*Greater works*” than He did! How so? As a mortal, Jesus could only be in one place at a time. His plan was to go to the Father, send the Holy Spirit, and the same miracle

working power He operated in to do these extraordinary works, would empower ALL believers. One cannot do greater works than raising the dead, but the intention of Jesus was for the power of God to so operate through believers, that the works He was doing would be done by believers worldwide.

THE CHURCH NEEDS TO SEEK TO EMULATE JESUS

Dictionary.com say's emulate means "*Imitate with effort to equal or surpass.*"

My question for us is, "*Are we making an effort to equal or surpass what Jesus did?*" If not, we should be!

When was the last time:

- We decide to have a family prayer meeting rather than making a doctor's appointment?
- We laid our hands on someone at work or in the marketplace believing for a miracle?

- Asked the Lord to lead us to someone who needed a miracle?
- We gave God an opportunity to perform a miracle, rather than resolving the matter with human effort?

Susan's grandpa Taylor said, *"Are we going to take stay here pills or believe the Lord?"*

A lot of people in the church want to know why miracles don't seem to happen on a regular basis? Let me ask it another way – When is the last time we started our day by asking the Lord, *"Lead me to someone who is in dire need of a miracle today, and give me the nerve to anoint them and pray for them."*

I think we should be specific with the Lord in activating miracles:

- Lord lead me to someone today who has diabetes...
- Lord lead me to someone today who has heart disease...

- Lord lead me to someone today who is in a wheelchair...
- Lord lead me to someone today who has Covid 19...

ALL BELIEVERS CAN PERFORM MIRACLES

What we normally refer to as “*The gift of miracles*,” is not actually “*The gift of miracles*”, it is “*the gift of working of miracles*.”

The definition of this gift is as follows:

- Working – Energema... (en-erg'-ay-mah)
Active, efficient operation.
- Miracles – Dunamis... (doo'-nam-is)
Miraculous power or ability...

Based on this information, we could define this gift as the active, efficient operation of miraculous powers or abilities.

In his book *"The Gifts of the Spirit,"* Harold Horton defines miracles in the following ways:

- *"A miracle is a supernatural act on the natural plane."*
- *"Works contrary to nature, accomplishments, so to speak, of the impossible, sudden and unaccountable reversals of the order to which we are accustomed."*
- *"A miracle is a supernatural intervention in the ordinary course of nature; a temporary suspension of the accustomed order; an interruption of the system of nature as we know it."*
- *"A miracle is a sovereign act of the Spirit of God irrespective of laws or systems."*

We all know God to be a God of miracles. To be used in this important gift, we must move beyond the belief that He is able to believing He wants to use us to work His miracles. The most important thing for us to understand concerning this gift is that the gift has more to do with the

worker of miracles than it does with the need for a miracle or the willingness on God's part to furnish the power for the miracle.

No doubt about it, God desires to furnish miracles in our midst and there is certainly an overabundance of needs for miracles. So, the question becomes, how do we get ourselves into a position to be used in the working of miracles?

In his book *"The Gifts of the Spirit,"* Harold Horton states, *"Those who produce such works through this gift are strikingly called by a word in the Greek that might be rendered 'miraclers', or, perhaps better, 'miraclers' of miracles."*

The power to produce a miracle is from the Holy Spirit – ***"Greater is He that is in us than he that is in the world."***

The need for miracles is literally everywhere!

The opportunity for a miracle must flow through those who are seeking to emulate Jesus! It is time for us to emulate Him!

CONCLUSION:

The following guidelines should be remembered and followed in the usage of this wonderful gift:

- Seek the gift... Ask God to use us to bring about a miracle.
- Be sensitive to the Holy Spirit with regard to when, where, and how He wants to bring about a miracle...
- Allow faith rather than fear to dominate our thoughts...
- Give the Holy Spirit opportunity to emulate Jesus through us...
- Be obedient to the instructions of the Holy Spirit...
- Speak the Word in faith with boldness...